

UAE HR Policy Reference (Sample)

Company HR policy summary, aligned with UAE Federal Decree-Law No. 33 of 2021 on the Regulation of Labour Relations. For internal reference and employee questions only; not a substitute for the full text of the law.

1. Probation Period

New employees may be placed on a probationary period not exceeding six (6) months from the start date of employment.

During probation, either the employer or the employee may end the employment relationship by giving at least fourteen (14) days' written notice, unless the employee is leaving to join another employer in the UAE, in which case at least one (1) month's notice is required.

An employee may only be placed on probation once by the same employer.

2. Annual Leave Entitlement

An employee who has completed one (1) year of continuous service is entitled to thirty (30) calendar days of paid annual leave per year.

An employee who has completed at least six (6) months but less than one (1) year of service is entitled to two (2) days of paid leave per month worked.

Annual leave may be carried over or paid out in cash for unused days upon termination of the contract, in accordance with the employment agreement.

3. Notice Period for Resignation or Termination

Either party wishing to terminate an unlimited or limited-term employment contract must give written notice to the other party.

The notice period must be no less than thirty (30) days and no more than ninety (90) days, as agreed in the employment contract. Unless otherwise specified, the standard notice period is thirty (30) days.

During the notice period, the employee is entitled to full pay and normal working conditions, and either party may request early release subject to mutual agreement.

4. End-of-Service Gratuity

An employee who completes one (1) year or more of continuous service is entitled to end-of-service gratuity, calculated on the basis of the employee's basic wage (excluding allowances).

Gratuity accrues at twenty-one (21) days' basic wage for each of the first five (5) years of service, and thirty (30) days' basic wage for each additional year beyond five (5) years.

Total gratuity payable must not exceed two (2) years' total wage. Gratuity is calculated on a pro-rated basis for partial years of service.

5. Working Hours and Overtime

The standard working week is a maximum of eight (8) hours per day or forty-eight (48) hours per week, subject to variation by sector-specific Cabinet decisions.

During the holy month of Ramadan, daily working hours are reduced by two (2) hours for all employees.

Work performed beyond normal hours is considered overtime and must be compensated at the normal wage plus twenty-five percent (25%). Overtime performed between 10:00 p.m. and 4:00 a.m. is compensated at the normal wage plus fifty percent (50%).

6. Sick Leave Entitlement

An employee is entitled to a maximum of ninety (90) days of sick leave per year, which may be continuous or intermittent, after completing the probationary period.

The first fifteen (15) days of sick leave are paid at full wage, the next thirty (30) days at half wage, and any remaining days within the ninety (90) day limit are unpaid.

Sick leave must be supported by a medical report from an accredited health authority or medical provider.

7. Public Holidays

Employees are entitled to paid leave on official UAE public holidays as announced by the UAE government each year, including New Year's Day, Eid Al Fitr, Arafat Day and Eid Al Adha, Islamic New Year, Prophet Muhammad's Birthday, Commemoration Day, and UAE National Day.

If an employee is required to work on a public holiday, they are entitled to a replacement rest day or compensation of pay for that day plus a fifty percent (50%) additional payment.

This document is a simplified reference for demonstration purposes and summarizes general provisions of UAE Federal Decree-Law No. 33 of 2021. Specific entitlements may vary by employment contract, free zone regulations, or subsequent executive regulations and Cabinet resolutions.